

0.0.1 To Ambattha

ambatṭhasuttaṃ

1. Thus was heard by me. At one time the Auspicious One was wandering on tour in Kosala with a large Sangha of bhikkhus, with about five hundred bhikkhus, when they arrived at a brahmin village of the Kosalans named Icchanangala. There the Auspicious One dwelled in the forest thicket of Icchanangala at Icchanangala.

evaṃ me¹ sutāṃ ekāṃ samayaṃ bhagavā kosalasu cārikaṃ caramāno mahatā bhikkhusaṅghena saddhiṃ pañcamattehi bhikkhusatehi yena icchānaṅgalaṃ² nāma kosalānaṃ brāhmaṇagāmo tadavasari. tatra sudāṃ bhagavā icchānaṅgale³ viharati icchānaṅgalavanasaṇḍe.

2. At that time the brahmin Pokkharasati was reigning over Ukkattha, [a village] crowded with beings, with grass, food and water, a royal possession with grain, a gift to Brahmins, a royal gift given by king Pasenadi of Kosala. The brahmin Pokkharasati heard: “The good Gotama, son of the Sakyans, having gone forth from the Sakyan clan, while wandering on tour in Kosala with a large Sangha of bhikkhus, with about five hundred bhikkhus, has arrived at Icchanangala and is dwelling in the forest thicket of Icchanangala at Icchanangala. Now a good reputation has been spread about that Auspicious Gotama thus: “Truly is he the Auspicious One, the

Arahant, rightly self-awakened, excelling in knowledge and conduct, well-farer, knower of worlds, incomparable charioteer of tamed persons, teacher of devas and humans, awakened, auspicious.” Having realized this world with its devas, maras and brahmas, together with the population of samanas and brahmanas, devas and humans, he causes to make it known. He teaches the Dhamma that is good in the beginning, good in the middle, good in the end, with the right meaning and phrasing, making known the life of purity that is utterly perfect and pure. Now good is the sight of such arahants.”

tena kho pana samayena brāhmaṇo pokkharasāti⁴ ukkaṭṭhaṃ ajjhāvasati sattussadaṃ satinaṇṇakāṭṭhodaṃ sadhaññaṃ rājabhoggaṃ rañña pasena-dinā⁵ kosalena dinnaṃ rājadāyaṃ brahmadeyyaṃ. assosi kho brāhmaṇo pokkharasāti: “samaṇo khalu bho gotamo sakyaputto sakyakulā pabbajito kosalesu cārikaṃ caramāno mahatā bhikkhusaṅghena saddhiṃ pañcamattehi bhikkhusatehi icchānaṅgalam anuppatto icchānaṅgale viharati icchānaṅgalavanasaṇḍe. taṃ kho pana bhavantam gotamaṃ evaṃ kalyāṇo kittisaddo abbhuggato: “itipi so bhagavā arahaṃ sammāsambuddho vijjācaraṇasampanno sugato lokavidū anuttaro purisadammasārathi⁶ satthā devamanussānaṃ buddho bhagavā.⁷ so imaṃ lokaṃ sadevakaṃ samārakaṃ sabrahmakaṃ sassamaṇabrāhmaṇiṃ pajam sadevamanussaṃ sayam abhiñña sacchikatvā pavedeti. so dhammaṃ deseti ādikalyāṇaṃ majjhakalyāṇaṃ

pariyosānakalyāṇaṃ sātthaṃ sabyañjanaṃ⁸ kevalaparipuṇṇaṃ parisuddhaṃ brahmacariyaṃ pakāseti. sādhu kho pana tathārūpānaṃ arahataṃ dassanaṃ hotī”ti.

3. At that time there was the brahmin Pokkharasati’s pupil, the brahmin youth Ambattha, a knowledge master of the three vedas, of the vocabularies and the rituals, of the phonology and the etymology with the legends as the fifth, master of the verses and the grammar, well versed in the materialistic philosophy and the auspicious marks of a great man. He was accepted and acknowledged by his own teacher with regard to the doctrine of the three knowledges: “Of that which I know, that you know, of that which you know, that I know.”

tena kho pana samayena brāhmaṇassa pokkhara-sātissa ambattho nāma māṇavo⁹ antevāsī hoti ajjhāyako mantadharo tiṇṇaṃ vedānaṃ pāragū sanighaṇḍukeṭubhānaṃ sakkharappabhedānaṃ itihāsapañcamānaṃ padako veyyākaraṇo lokāyata-mahāpurisalakkhaṇesu anavayo anuññātapaṭiññāto sake ācariyake tevijjake pāvacane yamaṃ jānāmi taṃ tvam jānāsi, yaṃ tvam jānāsi tamahaṃ jānāmīti.

4. So then, the brahmin Pokkharasati addressed the brahmin youth Ambattha: “This samana Gotama, O my son Ambattha, son of the Sakyans, having gone forth

from the Sakyan clan, while wandering on tour in Kosala with a large Sangha of bhikkhus, with about five hundred bhikkhus, has arrived at Icchanangala and is dwelling in the forest thicket of Icchanangala at Icchanangala. Now a good reputation has been spread about that Auspicious Gotama thus: “Truly is he the Auspicious One, the Arahant, rightly self-awakened, excelling in knowledge and conduct, well-farer, knower of worlds, incomparable charioteer of tamed persons, teacher of devas and humans, awakened, auspicious.” Having realized this world with its devas, maras and brahmas, together with the population of samanas and brahmanas, devas and humans, he causes to make it known. He teaches the Dhamma that is good in the beginning, good in the middle, good in the end, with the right meaning and phrasing, making known the life of purity that is utterly perfect and pure. Now good is the sight of such arahants.” Come you, my son Ambattha, visit with the samana Gotama. Having approached the samana Gotama, find out whether the good reputation spread about that good Gotama is really true as reported or not true, whether the good Gotama is just so, or whether he is not just so. In this way we will find out about that good Gotama.”

atha kho brāhmaṇo pokkharasāti ambatṭhaṃ mā-
ṇavaṃ āmantesi: “ayaṃ tāta ambatṭha samaṇo
gotamo sakyaputto sakyakulā pabbajito kosalesu
cārikaṃ caramāno mahatā bhikkhusaṅghena sad-
dhiṃ pañcamattehi bhikkhusatehi icchānaṅgalaṃ
anuppatto icchānaṅgale viharati icchānaṅgalava-

nasande. tam kho pana bhavantam gotamam evam kalyāṇo kittisaddo abbhuggato: “itipi so bhagavā, araham sammāsambuddho -pe- brahmacariyam pakāseti. sādhu kho pana tathārūpānam arahatam dassanam hoti”ti. ehi tvam tāta ambatṭha, yena samaṇo gotamo tenupasaṅkama. upasaṅkamtivā samaṇam gotamam jānāhi yadi vā tam bhavantam gotamam tathāsantamyeva saddo abbhuggato, yadi vā no tathā, yadi vā so bhavam gotamo tādiso, yadi vā na tādiso, tathā mayam tam bhavantam gotamam vedissāmāti.

5. “But how can I sir, find out whether the good reputation spread about that good Gotama is really true as reported or not true, whether the good Gotama is just so, or whether he is not just so?”

“yathā katham panāham bho tam bhavantam gotamam jānissāmi yadi vā tam bhavantam gotamam tathāsantamyeva saddo abbhuggato, yadi vā no tathā, yadi vā so bhavam gotamo tādiso yadi vā na tādiso”ti.

6. “The thirty two auspicious marks of a great man, O my son Ambattha, has come down in our mantras, by which for the person endowed with those auspicious marks, there are only two destinies, no other. If he lives the home life, he becomes a wheel turning monarch, a righteous king ruling by the dhamma, victorious king

of the world who has attained stability of the country, endowed with the seven gems. That is: The wheel gem, the elephant gem, the horse gem, the jewel gem, the woman gem, the head of household gem, with the counsellor gem as the seventh. He has more than a thousand sons who are courageous, heroic, crushing the armies of others. He dwells having conquered by the Dhamma this earth bounded by the ocean without rod, without sword. If however, he goes forth from the home life into homelessness, then he becomes an arahant, a supremely awakened one, who rolls back the veil in the world. But I, O my son Ambattha, am a giver of the mantras, you are the recipient of the mantras.” “Yes Master,” the brahmin youth Ambattha, having replied to the brahmin Pokkharasati, having risen up from his seat, having bowed down, having circumambulated the brahmin Pokkharasati, having mounted a mare-drawn chariot, set out to the forest thicket of icchanangala with many young brahmins. Having gone as far as the ground was suitable [for vehicles], having descended from the vehicle, he entered the monastery on foot.

“āgatāni kho tātā ambatṭha, amhākaṃ mantesu dvattiṃsa mahāpurisalakkhaṇāni yehi samannāgatassa mahāpurisassa dveva gatiyo bhavanti anañña: sace agāraṃ ajjhāvasati rājā hoti cakkavattī dhammiko dhammarājā cāturato vijitāvī janapadatthāvariyaṃ patto sattaratanasamannāgato. tassimāni sattaratanāni bhavanti. seyyathidaṃ: cakkaratanam, hatthiratanam, assaratanam, maṇiratanam,

itthiratanam, gahapatiratanam, parināyakarata-nameva sattamam. parosahassam kho panassa puttā bhavanti sūrā vīraṅgarūpā parasenappamad-danā. so imam paṭhavim sāgarapariyantam adaṇḍena asatthena dhammena abhivijīya ajjhāvasati. sace kho pana agārasmā anagāriyam pabbajati araham hoti sammāsambuddho loka vivattacchado¹. aham kho pana tāta ambaṭṭha mantānam dātā tvaṃ mantānam paṭiggahetā”ti. “evaṃ bho’ti kho ambaṭṭho māṇavo brāhmaṇassa pokkharasātissa paṭissutvā uṭṭhāyāsanā brāhmaṇam pokkharasātim abhivādetvā padakkhiṇam katvā vaḷavārathamārūya sambahulehi māṇevahi¹ saddhim yena icchānaṅgalavanasaṇḍo tena pāyāsi. yāvatikā yānassa bhūmi yānena gantvā yānā paccorohitvā pattiko’va ārāmam pāvisi.

7. At that time many bhikkhus were walking up and down in the open air. So then the brahmin youth Ambattha approached those bhikkhus. Having approached, he said this to those bhikkhus: “Where sirs, is the good Gotama dwelling at present? Indeed we have come here to see the good Gotama.”

tena kho pana समयena sambahulā bhikkhū abbhokāse caṅkamanti. atha kho ambaṭṭho māṇavo yena te bhikkhū tenupasaṅkami. upasaṅkamitvā te bhikkhū etadavoca: “kahannu kho bho etarahi so bhavam gotamo viharati? taṃ hi mayam bha-

vantaṃ gotamaṃ dassanāya idhūpasāṅkantā”ti.

8. Then this occurred to those bhikkhus: “This brahmin youth Ambattha is of a distinguished family and a well-known pupil of the brahmin Pokkharasati, and it is not troublesome for the Auspicious One to hold friendly conversation with such a son of good family.” They said this to the brahmin youth Ambattha: It is this dwelling with the closed door, O Ambattha. Approach it quietly without rush, and upon arrival, having entered the verandah, having cleared your throat, knock on the cross-bar. The Auspicious One will open the door.

atha kho tesāṃ bhikkhūnaṃ etadahosi: “ayaṃ kho ambaṭṭho māṇavo abhiññātakolañño ceva abhiññātassa ca brāhmaṇassa pokkharasātissa antevāsī. agaru kho pana bhagavato evarūpehi kulaputtehi saddhiṃ kathāsallāpo hotī”ti. te ambaṭṭhaṃ māṇavaṃ etadavocuṃ: “eso ambaṭṭha vihāro saṃvutadvāro. tena appasaddo upasāṅkamitvā ataramāno ālindaṃ pavisitvā ukkāsitvā aggalaṃ ākoṭehi. vivarissati te bhagavā dvāranti.”

9. So then, the brahmin youth Ambattha, having approach the dwelling with the closed door quietly without rush, having entered the verandah, having cleared his throat, he knocked on the cross-bar. The Auspicious One opened the door. The brahmin youth Ambattha entered. The young brahmins too having entered, they exchanged

friendly greetings with the Auspicious One. Having exchanged friendly greetings and cordial talk, they sat down to one side. However, the brahmin youth Ambattha, while walking back and forth, exchanged some friendly greetings or other with the Auspicious One being seated. While standing too, he exchanged some friendly greetings or other with the Auspicious One being seated.

atha kho ambaṭṭho māṇavo yena so vihāro saṃvutadvāro tena appasaddo upasaṅkamitvā atara-māno ālindaṃ pavisitvā ukkāsitvā aggalaṃ ākoṭesi. vivari bhagavā dvāraṃ. pāvisi ambaṭṭho māṇavo. māṇavakā'pi pavisitvā bhagavatā saddhiṃ sammodiṃsu. sammodanīyaṃ kathaṃ sārāṇīyaṃ vītisāretvā ekamantaṃ nisīdiṃsu. ambaṭṭho pana māṇavo caṅkamanto'pi nisinnena bhagavatā kañci kañci kathaṃ sārāṇīyaṃ vītisāreti. ṭhito'pi nisinnena bhagavatā kañci kañci kathaṃ sārāṇīyaṃ vītisāreti.

10. Then the Auspicious One said this to the brahmin youth Ambattha: “Is that how you, O Ambattha, exchanged friendly greetings with brahmins who are aged, old men, teachers of teachers, just as you exchanged some friendly greetings or other with me sitting while you walk or stand?” “No indeed good Gotama. Indeed O good Gotama, it is suitable for a brahmin while walking, to converse with a brahmin who is walking. Indeed O good Gotama, it is suitable for a brahmin while standing,

to converse with a brahmin who is standing. Indeed O good Gotama, it is suitable for a brahmin while sitting, to converse with a brahmin who is sitting. Indeed O good Gotama, it is suitable for a brahmin while lying down, to converse with a brahmin who is lying down. But with those bald-headed counterfeit samana, O good Gotama, dark out-castes, offsprings of our kinsmen's feet, friendly greeting are exchanged with them by me just as with the good Gotama."

atha kho bhagavā ambatṭhaṃ māṇavaṃ etada-
voca: evannu kho te2 ambatṭha, brāhmaṇehi vud-
dhehi mahallakehi ācariyapācariyehi saddhiṃ ka-
thāsallāpo hoti yathayidaṃ caraṃ tiṭṭhaṃ nisin-
nena mayā kañci kañci kathaṃ sārāṇīyaṃ vīti-
sāreti?"ti "no hidaṃ bho gotama. gacchanto vā
hi bho gotama gacchantena brāhmaṇo brāhma-
ṇena saddhiṃ sallapitumarahati. ṭhito vā hi bho
gotama ṭhitena brāhmaṇo brāhmaṇena saddhiṃ
sallapitumarahati. nisinno vā hi bho gotama ni-
sinnena brāhmaṇo brāhmaṇena saddhiṃ sallapi-
tumarahati. sayāno vā hi bho gotama sayānena
brāhmaṇo brāhmaṇena saddhiṃ sallapitumarahati.
ye ca kho te bho gotama muṇḍakā samaṇakā ib-
bhā kaṇhā2 bandhupādāpaccā, tehipi me saddhiṃ
evaṃ kathāsallāpo hoti yathariva bhotā gotamenā"ti.

11. "But there was a purpose, O Ambattha, for you coming here. That very purpose for which you could

come, it is just that purpose that you should pay close attention to. This brahmin youth Ambattha is immature though he conceives himself to be mature. What else could that be due to apart from immaturity.”

“atthikavato kho pana te ambatṭha idhāgamaṇaṃ ahosi. yāyeva kho panatthāya āgaccheyyātho tamewa atthaṃ sādhukaṃ manasi kareyyātho¹. avusitavā yeva kho pana bho ayaṃ ambatṭho māṇavo vusitamānī² kimaññatra avusitattā”ti.

12. Then the brahmin youth Ambattha being called by the word, “immature,” by the Auspicious One, angry and displeased, really insulting the Auspicious One, really despising the Auspicious One, really criticizing the Auspicious One, [thinking]: “The good samana Gotama will suffer misfortune by me,” said this to the Auspicious One: “Wild, O good Gotama, are those of Sakyan birth.” “Rough, O good Gotama, are those of Sakyan birth.” “Touchy, O good Gotama, are those of Sakyan birth.” “Aggressive, O good Gotama, are those of Sakyan birth.” “Existing as subordinates, being subordinates, they neither honor the brahmins, nor esteem the brahmins, nor respect the brahmins, nor worship the brahmins, nor revere the brahmins. This, O good Gotama, is not pleasing, this is not proper, that these sakyans existing as subordinates, being subordinates, they neither honor the brahmins, nor esteem the brahmins, nor respect the brahmins, nor worship the brahmins, nor revere the brah-

mins.” Thus indeed, this is the first [time] the brahmin youth Ambattha denigrated the Sakyans with the word, “subordinates.”

atha kho ambaṭṭho māṇavo bhagavatā avusitavādena vuccamāno kupito anattamano bhagavantamyeva khumsento bhagavantamyeva vambhento bhagavantamyeva upavadamāno samaṇo ca me bho gotamo pāpito bhavissatīti bhagavantam eta-davoca: “caṇḍā bho gotama sakyajāti, pharusā bho gotama sakyajāti, lahusā bho gotama sakyajāti, rabhasā bho gotama sakyajāti, ibbhā santā ibbhā samānā na brāhmaṇe sakkaronti na brāhmaṇe garukaronti na brāhmaṇe mānenti na brāhmaṇe pūjenti na brāhmaṇe apacāyanti. tayidaṃ bho gotama nacchannaṃ tayidaṃ nappaṭirūpaṃ yadime sakyā ibbhā santā ibbhā samānā na brāhmaṇe sakkaronti na brāhmaṇe garukaronti na brāhmaṇe mānenti na brāhmaṇe pūjenti na brāhmaṇe apacāyantīti. itiha ambaṭṭho māṇavo idaṃ paṭhamam sakkesu ibbhavādam nipātesi.

13. “But what, O Ambattha, did those Sakyans do wrong against you?” At this one time, O good Gotama, I arrived at Kapilavatthu just on some business for my teacher, the brahmin Pokkharasati. I approached the council hall of the Sakyans. At that time many Sakyans and Sakyan youths were just sitting on high seats in the council hall poking each other with their fingers, joking, playing to-

gether, I think they were most certainly only making fun of me. No one invited me to a seat. This, O good Gotama, is not pleasing, this is not proper, that these sakyans existing as subordinates, being subordinates, they neither honor the brahmins, nor esteem the brahmins, nor respect the brahmins, nor worship the brahmins, nor revere the brahmins.” Thus indeed, this is the second [time] the brahmin youth Ambattha denigrated the Sakyans with the word, “subordinates.”

“kimpana te ambaṭṭha, sakyā aparaddhanti?” “eka midāhaṃ bho gotama, samayaṃ ācariyassa brāhmaṇassa pokkharasātissa kenacideva karaṇīyena kapilavatthum agamāsim. yena sakyānaṃ santhāgāraṃ tenupasaṅkamim. tena kho pana samayena sambahulā sakyā ceva sakyakumārā ca santhāgāre uccesu āsanesu nisinnā honti aññamaññaṃ aṅgulipatodakehi sañjagghantā saṃkīlantā aññadatthu mamaññeva mañña anujagghantā. na maṃ koci āsanena’pi nimantesi. tayidaṃ bho gotama nacchannaṃ, tayidaṃ nappaṭirūpaṃ, yadime sakyā ibbhā santā ibbhā samānā na brāhmaṇe sakkaronti na brāhmaṇe garukaronti na brāhmaṇe mānenti na brāhmaṇe pūjenti na brāhmaṇe apacāyanti”ti. itiha ambaṭṭho māṇavo idaṃ dutiyaṃ sakkesu ibbhavādaṃ nipātesi.

14. “Even a quail bird, O Ambattha, says whatever she wants in her own nest. But this, O Ambattha, is

the Sakyan's own [home], that is Kapilavatthu. It is not worthy of the venerable Ambattha to abuse [the Sakyans] over such a trifle."

"laṭukikāpi kho ambaṭṭha, sakuṇikā sake kulāvake kāmālāpinī hoti. sakaṃ kho panetaṃ ambaṭṭha sakyānaṃ yadidaṃ kapilavatthu. na arahatāyasmā ambaṭṭho imāya appamattāya abhisajjitunti."

15. There are, O good Gotama, these four castes: the Khattiya, the Brahmin, the Vessa and the Sudda. Of these four caste, O good Gotama, indeed the three castes, the Khattiyas, the Vessas and the Suddas are most certainly simply servants of the Brahmins. This, O good Gotama, is not pleasing, this is not proper, that these sakyans existing as subordinates, being subordinates, they neither honor the brahmins, nor esteem the brahmins, nor respect the brahmins, nor worship the brahmins, nor revere the brahmins." Thus indeed, this is the third [time] the brahmin youth Ambattha denigrated the Sakyans with the word, "subordinates."

"cattāro'me bho gotama, vaṇṇā: khattiyā brāhmaṇā vessā suddā. imesaṃ hi bho gotama cattunnaṃ vaṇṇānaṃ tayo vaṇṇā khattiyā ca vessā ca suddā ca aññadatthu brāhmaṇasseva paricārakā sampajjanti. tayidaṃ bho gotama nacchan-naṃ tayidaṃ nappaṭirūpaṃ yadi me sakyā ibbhā santā ibbhā samānā na brāhmaṇe sakkaronti na

brāhmaṇe garukaronti na brāhmaṇe mānenti na
brāhmaṇe pūjenti na brāhmaṇe apacāyanti”ti. itiha
ambatṭho māṇavo idaṃ tatiyaṃ sakkesu ibbhavā-
daṃ nipātesi.

16. Then of the Auspicious One this occurred: “This
brahmin youth Ambattha denigrades the Sakyans too
much with the word, “subordinates.” What if I were to
ask about his clan?” So then, the Auspicious One said
this to the brahmin youth, Ambattha: “What is you clan,
O Ambattha?”

atha kho bhagavato etadahosi: atibālhaṃ kho ayaṃ
ambatṭho māṇavo sakkesu ibbhavādena nimmā-
neti¹. yannūnāhaṃ gottam puccheyyanti. atha
kho bhagavā ambatṭhaṃ māṇavaṃ etadavoca: ‘ka-
thaṃ gottosi ambatṭhā?ti’

17. “I am a Kanhayana, good Gotama.”

“kaṇhāyano’hamasmi, bho gotamā”ti.

18. “But O Ambattha, remembering the name and clan
of your maternal and paternal ancestry, the Sakyans
are the sons of the master, you are the son of a female
slave of the Sakyans. The Sakyans, O Ambattha, regard
king Okkaka as their paternal grandfather. Formally, O
Ambattha, king Okkaka wishing to divert the kingdom to
the son of his royal consort, dear and beloved, exiled the

elder princes, Ukkamukha, Karakanda, Hatthinika and Nipura from the country. Exiled from the country, at the bank of a pond on the slopes of the himalayan mountains, there they made their home in a large teak grove. For fear of contaminating their bloodline, they arranged mating with their own sisters. So then, O Ambattha, king Okkaka addressed a privy councillor of his assembly: “Where, good man, are the princes at present?” There is a bank of a pond on the slopes of the himalayan mountains, O king. There they have made their home in a large teak grove. For fear of contaminating their bloodline, they arranged mating with their own sisters. So then, O Ambattha, king Okkaka uttered and inspired utterance: “Certainly the holding of one’s own [sakya], Sir, hold the princes. Certainly the foremost holding of one’s own [paramasakya], Sir, hold the princes.” Henceforth, O Ambattha, they were known as the Sakyans. Just he was their ancestor. But O ambatṭha, king Okkaka’s female slave was named Dasi. She indeed gave birth to a black [baby]. The black baby spoke: “Wash me mother, bathe me mother, set me free from this filth mother, and I will be of benefit to you.” Just as at present, O Ambattha, humans having seen a goblin, they recognize him as “A goblin.” So too, O Ambattha, at that time, humans recognized goblins as “Black.” They spoke thus: this baby speaks: “A black baby, a goblin baby.” Henceforth, O Ambattha, they were known as the Kanhayanas. And he was the ancestor of the Kanhayanas. Thus, O Ambattha, remembering the name and clan of your maternal and paternal ancestry, the Sakyans are the sons of the master,

you are the son of a female slave of the Sakyans.”

“porāṇaṃ kho pana te ambaṭṭha mātāpettikaṃ nāmagottaṃ anussarato ayyaputtā sakyā bhavanti, dāsiputto tvamasi sakyānaṃ. sakyā kho pana ambaṭṭha, rājānaṃ okkākaṃ pitāmahaṃ dahanti. “bhūtapubbaṃ ambaṭṭha, rājā okkāko yā sā mahesī piyā manāpā, tassā puttassa rajjaṃ pariṇāmetukāmo jeṭṭhakumāre raṭṭhasmā pabbājesi ukkāmu-khaṃ² karakaṇḍaṃ³ hatthinikaṃ nipuraṃ⁴. te raṭṭhasmā pabbājita himavantapasse pokkharaṇiyā tīre mahāsākasaṇḍo tattha vāsaṃ kappesaṃ. te jātisambhedabhayā sakāhi bhaginīhi saddhiṃ saṃvāsaṃ kappesaṃ. atha kho ambaṭṭha, rājā okkāko amacce pārisajje āmantesi: “kahanna kho bho etarahi kumārā sammantīti”? “atthi deva, himavantapasse pokkharaṇiyā tīre mahāsākasaṇḍo tatthetarahi kumārā sammanti. te jātisambhedabhayā sakāhi bhaginīhi saddhiṃ saṃvāsaṃ kappenti”ti. atha kho ambaṭṭha, rājā okkāko udānaṃ udānesi: “sakyā vata bho kumārā paramasakyā vata bho kumārā”ti. tadagge kho pana ambaṭṭha, sakyā paññāyanti. so’va¹ nesaṃ pubbapuriso. rañño ca kho pana ambaṭṭha, okkākassa disā nāma dāsī ahosi. sā kaṇhaṃ² nāma janesi. jāto kaṇho pabyāhāsi: “dhovatha maṃ amma, nahāpetha maṃ amma, imasmā maṃ amma asucismā parimocetha, atthāya vo bhavissāmī”ti. ya-thā kho pana ambaṭṭha, etarahi manussā pisāce disvā ‘pisācā’ti sañjānanti. evameva kho ambaṭ-

ṭha, tena samayena manussā pisāce ‘kaṇhā’ti sañ-
jānanti. te evamāhaṃsu: ayaṃ jāto pabyāhāsi:
‘kaṇho jāto, pisāco jāto’ti. tadagge kho pana am-
baṭṭha, kaṇhāyanā paññāyanti. so ca kaṇhāya-
nānaṃ pubbapuriso. iti kho te ambaṭṭha, porā-
ṇaṃ mātāpettikaṃ nāmagottaṃ anussarato ayya-
puttā sakyā bhavanti. dāsiputto tvamasi sakyā-
nanti.

19. When thus was said, those young brahmins said this to the Auspicious One: “Let not the good Gotamo disgrace the brahmin youth Ambattha too much, with the use of the words: “The son of a female slave.” Well-born, O good Gotama, is the brahmin youth Ambattha, and son of a good family is the brahmin youth Ambattha, and of great learning is the brahmin youth Ambattha, and eloquent is the brahmin youth Ambattha, and wise is the brahmin youth Ambattha, and the brahmin youth Ambattha is capable of discussing this matter with the good Gotama.”

evaṃ vutte te māṇavakā bhagavantam etadavocum: “mā bhavam gotamo ambaṭṭham māṇavam atibālham dāsiputtavādena nimmānesi. sujāto ca bho gotama, ambaṭṭho māṇavo kulaputto ca ambaṭṭho māṇavo bahussuto ca ambaṭṭho māṇavo kalyāṇavākkaraṇo ca ambaṭṭho māṇavo paṇḍito ca ambaṭṭho māṇavo. pahoti ca ambaṭṭho māṇavo bhotā gotamena saddhim asmim vacane pa-

ṭimantetu”nti.

20. Then the Auspicious One said this to those young brahmins: “If it occurs to you, O young brahmins thus: “Ill-born is the brahmin youth Ambattha, and not son of a good family is the brahmin youth Ambattha, and of little learning is the brahmin youth Ambattha, and ineloquent is the brahmin youth Ambattha, and unwise is the brahmin youth Ambattha, and the brahmin youth Ambattha is not capable of discussing this matter with the good Gotama,” then let the brahmin youth Ambattha, stand aside, and you all discuss the matter with me. If however, it occurs to you young brahmins thus: “Well-born, O good Gotama, is the brahmin youth Ambattha, and son of a good family is the brahmin youth Ambattha, and of great learning is brahmin youth Ambattha, and eloquent is the brahmin youth Ambattha, and wise is the brahmin youth Ambattha, and the brahmin youth Ambattha is capable of discussing this matter with the good Gotama,” then you all stand aside, and let the brahmin youth Ambattha, discuss the matter with me.”

atha kho bhagavā te māṇavake etadavoca: “sace kho tumhākaṃ māṇavakā evaṃ hoti ‘dujjāto ca ambatṭho māṇavo, akulaputto ca ambatṭho māṇavo, appassuto ca ambatṭho māṇavo, akalyāṇavākkaraṇo ca ambatṭho māṇavo, duppañño ca ambatṭho māṇavo, na ca pahoti ambatṭho māṇavo samaṇena gotamena saddhiṃ asmim vacane pa-

ṭimantetunti, tiṭṭhatu ambaṭṭho māṇavo, tumhe mayā saddhiṃ mantayavho¹ asmiṃ vacane. sace pana tumhākaṃ māṇavakā evaṃ hoti: sujāto ca ambaṭṭho māṇavo, kulaputto ca ambaṭṭho māṇavo, bahussuto ca ambaṭṭho māṇavo, kalyāṇavākkaraṇo ca ambaṭṭho māṇavo, paṇḍito ca ambaṭṭho māṇavo, pahoti ca ambaṭṭho māṇavo samaṇena gotamena saddhiṃ asmiṃ vacane paṭimantetunti, tiṭṭhatha tumhe, ambaṭṭho māṇavo mayā saddhiṃ paṭimantetū”ti.

21. “Well-born, O good Gotama, is the brahmin youth Ambattha, and son of a good family is the brahmin youth Ambattha, and of great learning is the brahmin youth Ambattha, and eloquent is the brahmin youth Ambattha, and wise is brahmin youth Ambattha, and the brahmin youth Ambattha is capable of discussing this matter with the good Gotama,” We will be silent. The brahmin youth Ambattha, is to discuss this matter with the good Gotama.”

“sujāto ca bho gotama ambaṭṭho māṇavo, kulaputto ca ambaṭṭho māṇavo, bahussuto ca ambaṭṭho māṇavo, kalyāṇavākkaraṇo ca ambaṭṭho māṇavo, paṇḍito ca ambaṭṭho māṇavo, pahoti ca ambaṭṭho māṇavo bhotā gotamena saddhiṃ asmiṃ vacane paṭimantetum. tuṇhī mayaṃ bhavissāma. ambaṭṭho māṇavo bhotā gotamena saddhiṃ asmiṃ vacane paṭimantetū”ti.

22. Then the Auspicious One said this to the brahmin youth Ambaṭṭha: “This legitimate question, O Ambattha comes for you. Even if you do not like it, it should be answered. If you do not answer, or respond with a different topic, or will become silent, or go away, your head will split into seven pieces right here. So what do you think, O Ambattha? What have you heard said by brahmins of old, of ancient times, teachers of teachers, speaking about the origin of the Kanhayanas, about who was the ancestor of the Kanhayanas?” When thus was said, the brahmin youth Ambattha became silent. Also for a second time, the Auspicious One said this to the brahmin youth Ambattha: “So what do you think, O Ambattha? What have you heard said by brahmins of old, of ancient times, teachers of teachers, speaking about the origin of the Kanhayanas, about who was the ancestor of the Kanhayanas?” Also for a second time, the brahmin youth Ambattha became silent. So then the Auspicious One said this to the brahmin youth Ambattha: “Answer now, O Ambattha. Now is not the appropriate time for your silence. He who does not answer a legitimate question from the Tathagata, O Ambattha, up to the third time [asking], his head will split into seven pieces right here.”

atha kho bhagavā ambatṭhaṃ māṇavaṃ etada-
voca: ayaṃ kho pana te ambatṭha, sahadham-
miko pañho āgacchati. akāmāpi vyākātabbo. sace
tvam na vyākariṣṣasi aññena vā aññaṃ paṭica-
rissasi, tuṇhī vā bhavissasi, pakkamissasi vā et-

theva te sattadhā muddhā phalissati. taṃ kiṃ maññasi ambatṭha? kinti te sutam brāhmaṇānaṃ vuddhānaṃ mahallakānaṃ ācariyapācariyānaṃ bhāsamānānaṃ kutopabhutikā kaṇhāyanā? ko ca kaṇhāyanānaṃ pubbapuriso?ti evaṃ vutte ambatṭho māṇavo tuṇhī ahosi. dutiyampi kho bhagavā ambatṭham māṇavaṃ etadavoca: taṃ kim maññasi ambatṭha? kinti te sutam brāhmaṇānaṃ vuddhānaṃ mahallakānaṃ -pe- ko ca kaṇhāyanānaṃ pubbapuriso?ti dutiyampi kho ambatṭho māṇavo tuṇhī ahosi. atha kho bhagavā ambatṭham māṇavaṃ etadavoca: vyākarohi 'dāni ambatṭha, na'dāni te tuṇhībhāvassa kālo. yo kho ambatṭha tathāgatena yāvatatīyakaṃ sahadhammikaṃ pañhaṃ puṭṭho na vyākaroti etthevassa sattadhā muddhā phalissati.

23. On that occasion the yakkha Vajirapani taking a huge iron hammer that was in flames, burning, blazing, was standing in the air above the brahmin youth Ambattha [thinking]: “If this brahmin youth Ambattha does not answer a legitimate question from the Auspicious One up to the third time [asking], I will split his head into seven pieces right here.” But only the Auspicious One and the brahmin youth Ambattha [could] see the yakkha Vajirapani.

tena kho pana samayena vajirapāṇi yakkho mahantaṃ ayokūṭaṃ ādāya ādittaṃ sampajjalitaṃ

sajotibhūtaṃ ambaṭṭhassa māṇavassa uparivehāsaṃ ṭhito hoti: sacāyaṃ ambaṭṭho māṇavo bhagavatā yāvatatīyakam sahadhammikaṃ pañhaṃ puṭṭho na vyākarissati, etthevassa sattadhā mudham phālessāmīti. taṃ kho pana vajirapāṇiṃ yakkhaṃ bhagavā ceva passati ambaṭṭho ca māṇavo.

24. Then the brahmin youth Ambattha being frightened, moved by fear, with hairs standing on end, seeking shelter from the Auspicious One, seeking protection from the Auspicious One, seeking refuge from the Auspicious One, sitting closer to the Auspicious One said this to the Auspicious One: “What is it that the good Gotama said to me? May the good Gotamo say it again?” “So what do you think, O Ambattha? What have you heard said by brahmins of old, of ancient times, teachers of teachers, speaking about the origin of the Kanhayanas, about who was the ancestor of the Kanhayanas?” “So too has been heard by me, good Gotama, just as the good Gotama has said. that is the origin of the Kanhayanas, and he was the ancestor of the Kanhayanas.”

atha kho ambaṭṭho māṇavo bhīto saṃviggo loma-haṭṭhajāto bhagavantamyeva tāṇagavesī bhagavantamyeva leṇagavesī bhagavantamyeva saraṇagavesī upanīṣīditvā bhagavantam etadavoca: “kiṃ me taṃ bhavaṃ gotamo āha? puna bhavaṃ gotamo bravītū”ti. “taṃ kimmaññasi ambaṭṭha? kinti

te sutam brāhmaṇānaṃ vuddhānaṃ mahallakānaṃ ācariyapācariyānaṃ bhāsamānānaṃ, kutoppabhutikā kaṇhāyanā? ko ca kaṇhāyanānaṃ pubbapuriso?ti.” “evameva me bho gotama sutam, yatheva bhavam gotamo āha. tatoppabhutikā kaṇhāyanā. so ca kaṇhāyanānaṃ pubbapuriso”ti.

25. When thus was said those young brahmins became noisy, making a great noise, a loud noise [saying]: “Apparently, Sir, the brahmin youth Ambattha is ill-born. Apparently, Sir, the brahmin youth Ambattha is not a son of a good family. Apparently, Sir, the brahmin youth Ambattha is a son of a female slave of the Sakyans. Apparently, Sir, the Sakyans are the sons of the master of the brahmin youth Ambattha. apparently the samana Gotama speaks just the truth, [yet] we presumed he should be disparaged.”

evam vutte te māṇavakā unnādino uccāsaddama-hāsaddā ahesum: “dujjāto kira bho ambaṭṭho māṇavo, akulaputto kira bho ambaṭṭho māṇavo, dāsiputto kira bho ambaṭṭho māṇavo sakyānaṃ, ayaputtā kira bho ambaṭṭhassa māṇavassa sakyā bhavanti. dhammavādiṃ yeva kira mayaṃ samaṇaṃ gotamaṃ apasādetabbaṃ amaññimhā”ti.

26. So then of the Auspicious One this occurred: “These young brahmins disgrace the brahmin youth ambattha too much with the use of the words: “The son of a fe-

male slave.” What if I were to set him free.” So then the Auspicious One said this to those young brahmins: “Let not you young brahmins disgrace the brahmin youth ambattha too much with the use of the words: “The son of a female slave.” Mighty was Kanha, the seer. He, having gone to the southern country, having learnt by heart the mantra of the brahmins, having approached king Okkaka, he asked for his daughter Mattharupi in marriage. King Okkaka [saying] Unbelievable! Who, being just the son of my female slave, would ask for my daughter Mattharupi in marriage.” Being angry and displeased, he drew [a bow with] a razor-tipped arrow. He was just unable to either release that razor-tipped arrow nor withdraw it. So then, O young brahmins, the privy counsellors of his assembly, having approached Kanha, the seer, said this: “Let there be safety for the king, O venerable sir. Let there be safety for the king, O venerable sir. ” “There will be safety for the king. But if the king were to release the razor-tipped arrow downwards, then the earth will split open as far as his kingdom extends.” “Let there be safety for the king, O venerable sir. Let there be safety for the country, O venerable sir.” “There will be safety for the king. There will be safety for the country. But if the king were to release the razor-tipped arrow upwards, then the [rain] Deva will not rain for seven years as far as his kingdom extends.” “Let there be safety for the king, O venerable sir. Let there be safety for the country, O venerable sir, and let the [rain] Deva rain.” “There will be safety for the king. There will be safety for the country, and the [rain] Deva will rain. But

if the king were to shoot the razor-tipped arrow at his eldest son, the prince will be safe. The prince will not be harmed.” So then, O young brahmins, king Okkaka’s privy councillors addressed [him saying]: O king, shoot the razor-tipped arrow at your eldest son. The prince will be safe. The prince will not be harmed. So king Okkaka shot the razor-tipped arrow at his eldest son. The prince was safe. The prince was not harmed. So then being frightened, moved by fear, with hairs standing on end, fearing the disfavor of the gods, king Okkaka gave his daughter. Let not you young brahmins disgrace the brahmin youth ambattha too much with the use of the words: “The son of a female slave.” Mighty was Kanha, the seer.”

atha kho bhagavato etadahosi: “atibālhaṃ kho ime māṇavakā ambatthaṃ māṇavaṃ dāsiputtavādena nimmānenti. yannūnāhaṃ parimoceyyanti.”
 atha kho bhagavā te māṇavake etadavoca: “mā kho tumhe māṇavakā ambatthaṃ māṇavaṃ atibālhaṃ dāsiputtavādena nimmānetha. ulāro so kaṇho isi ahosi. so dakkhiṇaṃ janapadaṃ gantvā brahme mante adhiyitvā rājānaṃ okkākaṃ upasaṅkamitvā maṭṭharūpiṃ¹ dhītaraṃ yāci. tassa rājā okkāko ‘ko neva re ayaṃ mayhaṃ dāsiputto samāno maṭṭharūpiṃ dhītaraṃ yācatī’ti kupito anat-tamano khurappaṃ sannayhi. so taṃ khurappaṃ neva asakkhi muñcituṃ, no paṭisaṃharituṃ. atha kho māṇavakā amaccā pārisajjā kaṇhaṃ isiṃ upasaṅkamitvā etadavocuṃ: “sothhi bhadante hotu rañño, sothhi bhadante hotu rañño”ti. “sothhi bha-

vissati rañño, api ca rājā yadi adho khurappaṃ muñcissati yāvatā rañño vijitaṃ ettāvatā paṭhavī udriyissatī”ti. “sotthi bhadante hotu rañño, sotthi janapadassā”ti. “sotthi bhavissati rañño, sotthi janapadassa. api ca rājā yadi uddhaṃ khurappaṃ muñcissati yāvatā rañño vijitaṃ ettāvatā sattavassāni devo na vassissatī”ti. “sotthi bhadante hotu rañño, sotthi janapadassa, devo ca vassatū”ti. “sotthi bhavissati rañño, sotthi janapadassa, devo ca vassissati. api ca rājā jeṭṭhakumāre khurappaṃ patitṭhāpetu, sotthi kumāro, pallomo bhavissatī”ti. atha kho māṇavakā, amaccā okkākassa ārocesuṃ: “devo jeṭṭhakumāre khurappaṃ patitṭhāpetu, sotthi kumāro pallomo bhavissatī”ti. atha kho rājā okkāko jeṭṭhakumāre khurappaṃ patitṭhāpesi. sotthi kumāro pallomo bhavi. atha kho tassa rājā okkāko bhīto saṃviggo loma-hatṭhajāto brahmadandaṇḍena tajjito maṭṭharūpiṃ dhītaraṃ adāsi. mā kho tumhe māṇavakā ambaṭṭhaṃ māṇavaṃ atibālhaṃ dāsiputtavādena nim-mānetha. ulāro so kaṇho isi ahosi.

